

# Engineering College Cheat Sheet

Score any college in under 10 minutes · Compare three options side by side · Let the data — not the brochure — decide

**Step 1.** Fill Part A (parents) or Part B (student) for each college you're considering. **Step 2.** Fill Part C for each branch-college combo on your shortlist. **Step 3.** Add college score + best branch score in Part D. **Step 4.** Highest total wins. Tie? Branch score breaks it.

## KEY FORMULAS — Calculate These Before Any Campus Visit

|                          |                                                                                 |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fill Rate</b>         | Total students admitted ÷ AICTE-sanctioned intake × 100                         |
| <b>Placement %</b>       | Students placed ÷ Total students enrolled × 100 (not just placement-registered) |
| <b>Idle Output Index</b> | (Total enrolled – Placed – Higher Studies) ÷ Total enrolled × 100               |
| <b>Median Salary</b>     | Middle salary from NIRF data — ignore the highest figure in the brochure        |

## PART A — Parent Scorecard (10 Points)

Four data points every parent should check — all available on the NIRF dashboard.

| Criterion         | Max | 0 pts  | 1 pt    | 2 pts   | 3 pts  |
|-------------------|-----|--------|---------|---------|--------|
| Fill Rate         | 3   | ≤60%   | 61–70%  | 71–85%  | >85%   |
| Placement %       | 2   | ≤65%   | 65–80%  | >80%    | —      |
| Median Salary     | 3   | ≤5 LPA | 5–6 LPA | 6–8 LPA | >8 LPA |
| Idle Output Index | 2   | >40%   | 21–40%  | ≤20%    | —      |

| Criterion              | College 1 | College 2 | College 3 |
|------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| Fill Rate (/3)         |           |           |           |
| Placement % (/2)       |           |           |           |
| Median Salary (/3)     |           |           |           |
| Idle Output Index (/2) |           |           |           |
| <b>Total</b>           |           |           |           |

**Total Part A:** \_\_\_\_\_ / 10

## PART B — Student Scorecard (15 Points) · Use if student visits campus

Same four criteria as Part A, plus **Campus Vibe /5** scored by the student. Vibe scoring: 0 = no impression · 1–2 = it was okay · 3–4 = felt good · 5 = loved it

| Criterion              | College 1 | College 2 | College 3 |
|------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| Fill Rate (/3)         |           |           |           |
| Placement % (/2)       |           |           |           |
| Median Salary (/3)     |           |           |           |
| Idle Output Index (/2) |           |           |           |
| Campus Vibe (/5)       |           |           |           |
| <b>Total</b>           |           |           |           |

**Total Part B:** \_\_\_\_\_ / 15

## PART C — Branch Scorecard (10 Points)

Score the specific branch you are considering at each college. Fill in up to four combinations.

| Criterion            | Max | 0 pts | 1 pt   | 2 pts  | 3 pts | 4 pts |
|----------------------|-----|-------|--------|--------|-------|-------|
| Branch Placement %   | 3   | ≤60%  | 61–80% | 80–90% | >90%  | —     |
| COEs for Branch      | 3   | 0     | 1      | 2      | ≥3    | —     |
| 6-Month+ Internships | 4   | ≤50%  | —      | 51–70% | —     | >70%  |

| Criterion                 | Option 1 | Option 2 | Option 3 | Option 4 |
|---------------------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| Branch Placement % (/3)   |          |          |          |          |
| COEs for Branch (/3)      |          |          |          |          |
| 6-Month+ Internships (/4) |          |          |          |          |
| <b>Total</b>              |          |          |          |          |

**Total Part C:** \_\_\_\_\_ / 10

## PART D — Final Combined Score

Add college score (Part A or B) + best branch score (Part C). Use the same part for all three colleges.

| Criterion                     | College 1 | College 2 | College 3 |
|-------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| College Score — Parent (/10)  |           |           |           |
| Best Branch Score (/10)       |           |           |           |
| <b>Parent Total (/20)</b>     |           |           |           |
| College Score — Student (/15) |           |           |           |
| Best Branch Score (/10)       |           |           |           |
| <b>Student Total (/25)</b>    |           |           |           |
| <b>Final Rank</b>             |           |           |           |

## QUICK TIPS

### Fill Rate

Use AICTE-sanctioned intake — not today's class size. Quiet reductions hide poor demand.

### Placement %

Ask: placed out of how many total? Include everyone enrolled, not just placement-registered students.

### Idle Output Index

Above 30% = serious red flag. Below 20% = healthy. This number never appears in any brochure.

### COEs

A Centre of Excellence for your branch = real investment. A name on a door means nothing.

### Campus Vibe

Walk up to random students in the canteen. The college arranged some tours — talk to the others.

### Tie-breaker

Same score on two colleges? The stronger branch score wins. That's closer to your actual career.